

Partnership Proposal: GGP x Take-Two Interactive

The Directory as our new spine · 12 Months · July 2026 to July 2027

Prepared by Gay Gaming Professionals · Draft 7 · June 3, 2026

Cover

To: Alan Lewis, VP Corporate Communications & Public Affairs, Take-Two Interactive (cc as appropriate: Chanel Ward, Molly Sewalk, Ethan Friedman / 2K leadership; Isabella Begazo, T2 NY) **From:** Gordon Bellamy, CEO, Gay Gaming Professionals **Subject:** The Directory as our new spine. Three options. July 2026 to July 2027. **Read-ahead for:** the next standing **EXCELLENCE** cadence meeting

What this proposal is

The Directory is ready. The **US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline** is a board-ready map of the field, from elementary through graduate, with **AI readiness** as a first-class category and "**where dollars go furthest**" tags on every entry. It launches at **gaygamingpros.org/directory** this summer. With Take-Two as the named launch partner, the Directory becomes the structural anchor of games-education infrastructure for everyone, not just our cohort. **That is the spine of this year's partnership renewal.** Everything else (CYSTEM, the 2K Studio Tour, the Scholars Breakfast, the new AI Readiness track) continues underneath it.

Why now

Six years of Take-Two partnership, **every year since 2019, the same year our GGP Scholars program launched**, with the CYSTEM Mentorship Program (2023), the annual 2K Studio Tour at GDC (a tradition you personally participate in), and the GGP Scholars Breakfast at GDC 2026 that Christopher Kim coordinated. Our most consistent corporate partnership in twenty years of GGP, and the partner who has been with us since the Scholars program existed. **Pride 2026 is in cycle this month**, AI readiness has become the threshold question for talent attraction in games, and the rising generation is graduating into the hardest entry-level market in two decades. **The Directory is how Take-Two anchors the field at the exact moment the field needs an anchor.**

Three options at a glance

Option	Investment	Best for
A · Directory Launch	\$40,000	Anchor the Directory as a public good with Take-Two as named launch partner
B · Directory + Pipeline + AI ★	\$100,000	The best year of the partnership, inside Alan's existing budget envelope
C · Multi-Year Flagship	\$250,000 over 24 months	Two-year flagship with co-branded Directory and full pipeline support

Recommendation: Option B. It anchors the Directory, continues every existing tradition, and adds the AI layer 2026 calls for.

Option A · Directory Launch · \$40,000

12-month engagement · launches summer 2026

The Directory exists in draft. Option A funds the public launch and Year-1 maintenance as a Take-Two-anchored resource.

- Public web launch of the US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline at **gaygamingpros.org/directory**

- Filterable and searchable interface (age, region, cost, audience served, AI-readiness)
- **"Powered by Take-Two Interactive, launch partner"** attribution prominently displayed
- 200+ programs at launch with verified scope data; quarterly refresh for 12 months
- Annual usage report with downloadable cuts for funders and educators
- Press cycle at Pride 2026 launch: GamesBeat, PocketGamer.biz, Polygon, EdSurge

What we own: build, hosting, editorial standards, quarterly refresh, press **What Take-Two owns:** launch-partner brand approvals, launch comms participation

Honest assessment: Option A is the structural anchor. It positions Take-Two as the partner who made navigation of the games-education field possible. It does *not* extend CYSTEM, the Studio Tour, the Breakfast, or fund AI readiness curriculum. Several pieces of value are left on the table.

Option B · Directory + Pipeline + AI ★ · \$100,000

Our recommended choice

12-month engagement · spans Pride 2026 to GDC 2027 to Pride 2027

Option B includes the Directory at launch scale, continues every existing tradition, and adds the AI readiness layer. **At \$100K, this is the best year of the partnership in dollar terms while still inside the budget envelope you already operate in.** Six-year cumulative T2 history: \$162,500. \$100K in one year is a credible stretch from there, anchored on the existing relationship.

B.1 · Directory Launch + Year-1 Maintenance (\$50,000)

Everything in Option A, plus: - Donor-facing dashboard: gap maps, cost-per-outcome, "where dollars go furthest" surfaced as a funder lens - Verified outcomes data for the top 50 programs (research procurement is the work this funds) - AI-readiness overlay tagging every entry - Expanded launch scope to ~250 programs with deeper data

B.2 · Named Take-Two CYSTEM Cohort (\$30,000)

A 12-month cohort of **10 scholars. CYSTEM Year 4** under Alex Rogers's continued leadership. Take-Two named on the cohort; scholarship dollars stacked from the existing CYSTEM funder mix to reach full per-scholar amounts.

- \$2,500 Take-Two anchor portion per scholar × 10 = \$25,000 (stacks with CYSTEM co-funders)
- \$5,000 cohort coordination, GDC travel support, mentor onboarding
- 1-on-1 ERG mentor pairings (each scholar matched with a Take-Two ERG member)
- 6 mentor sessions over the year, GGP-curated

B.3 · 2K Studio Tour + Scholars Breakfast at GDC 2027 (\$15,000)

- Underwrites the **2K Studio Tour** for the cohort and the **GGP Scholars Breakfast** in San Francisco
- Both are existing traditions Alan personally values and participates in
- Take-Two named as industry sponsor in press and our annual report

B.4 · AI Readiness Track (\$5,000)

- "AI in the Studio" curriculum module added to CYSTEM
- 1 to 2 AI fluency office hours led by Take-Two engineers
- "AI in the Studio" segment within the 2K Studio Tour at GDC 2027

Outcomes (12 months): - Directory live by Pride 2026; 5,000+ unique users in year 1; 250+ programs at launch; quarterly refresh on schedule - 1,500+ press impressions across the Pride 2026 launch cycle - 10 scholars deployed; 80% mentor pairing completion; **at least 3 cohort members in industry roles by July 2027** - 45+ scholars at the 2K Tour and Breakfast at GDC 2027 - 100% of cohort completes the AI module; at least 3 case-study reflections published

Option C · Multi-Year Flagship · \$250,000 over 24 months

\$125,000 per year average · July 2026 to July 2028

If Take-Two wants to make GGP x Take-Two a named multi-year flagship anchored on the Directory.

Adds to Option B: - Year 2 mirroring of the cohort, Studio Tour, and Breakfast - Directory expanded to 400+ programs with full verified outcomes data, hosted under prominent co-branding: **"Powered by Take-Two Interactive"** - New York mirror of the GGP x G4C charity poker tournament (Mike + Amy Morhaime's inaugural funded two scholars for 2026 to 2027; appetite to mirror) - *Optional add-on:* a second "Belonging Round 3" video series in 2027 (~\$30K incremental)

Honest assessment: Option C is a real commitment at \$125K per year for two years. It would make GGP x Take-Two the most visible games-education infrastructure partnership in the industry at this tier. We are not pushing it unless the bandwidth is there.

What we need from Take-Two

1. **Alan as point person**, with a 2K and Zynga ERG liaison
2. **Launch-partner brand approval** for the Directory and co-branding rights under staged review
3. **ERG access** for the mentor pool (15+) and brief AI engineer office hours (1 to 2 sessions)
4. **An MOU and contract.** Option B paid in three tranches: 50% at kickoff (July 2026), 25% at Directory public launch, 25% at GDC 2027

Risk + mitigation

Risk	Mitigation
Budget constraint in 2026	Option A is the fallback; Option B components are modular
Directory launch delays	Phased release (beta then public); decoupled from GDC 2027 deliverables
Mentor matching at scale	GGP pre-recruits 15+ Take-Two ERG mentors; monthly office hours

Risk	Mitigation
Outcomes data not yet complete	Top 50 verified at launch; longer-tail flagged as scope-only and filled in across the year

Why GGP

- **Track record.** 20 years cultivating top performers. First GGP Scholar Alum on **Forbes 30 Under 30** (Games, Sept 2025): **Joseph Kemp, CEO of Games That Matter LLC** (creator of *Disbarred*, the legal-education card game). Audrey Webb at Roblox. Ami Cai at NYS Empire State Development. Christopher Kim at USC Marshall.
- **Pipeline depth and ecosystem position.** Five programs each touching different points of the pipeline (GGP Scholars, CYSTEM, Collegiate Games Challenge, Global Game Jam host, GGP x G4C funded scholars). Already at the connective tissue with **Bigglesworth Family Foundation** (Sinjin Bain) on the IGNITE Impact Challenge and **Games for Change** on the Mike + Amy Morhaime charity poker tournament. **Tracy Fullerton (USC Games)** and **Ben Golant (Tencent)** are on the G4C board with us.
- **Operational stability.** **Eric Francksen formally takes the title Executive Producer, GGP, in 2026.** Six years of operational backbone behind the 2K Studio Tour, the Scholars Breakfast, and the CYSTEM cadence with Take-Two.

Companion documents

- **US Video Game Education and Scholars Pipeline, Starter Directory, Draft 3** (attached; the artifact this proposal launches)
- Pipeline One-Sheet (available on request)
- Relationship Research Brief, Draft 2 (internal; available on request)

Next step

A 30-minute call with Alan, and whoever from 2K he wants on the line, at the next **EXCELLENCE** cadence to:

1. Confirm Option B (or remix)
2. Co-develop the Directory launch comms and Pride 2026 cycle
3. Lock the budget tranche structure
4. Calendar the GDC 2027 moment

The Directory launches this summer. The Pride 2026 press window is open right now. Alan, name the date and we will be there.

*Built to be shared with the Take-Two Foundation board. Easy to read, easy to forward, easy to say yes to. The Directory is the asset this proposal puts in your board's hands.***